AJAY KUMAR TAKIAR

Associate Professor of Finance | Vice Director – Academic Affairs
International Institute of Accounting and Finance (IIAF), University of Finance and Economics, Mongolia
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MBA | CMA | CGMA | ACMA | CFE | FPAC | CSCA | FRM in progress

ACADEMIC PROFILE

Associate Professor of Finance and Vice Director – Academic Affairs with over 18 years of experience in university teaching, academic leadership, and professional finance education. His academic interests are centred on corporate finance, particularly capital structure, debt maturity, cost of capital, financial distress, and firm value in emerging-market listed firms. He is pursuing a PhD in Finance at Putra Business School, Malaysia (commenced 2026), examining how debt maturity affects firm value through the cost-of-capital channel under financial distress risk in Malaysian non-financial listed firms. He holds an MBA with a GPA of 3.96/4.00 and professional qualifications including CMA, CGMA, ACMA, CFE, FPAC, and CSCA.

DOCTORAL RESEARCH

Debt Maturity and Firm Value in Malaysian Listed Firms: The Cost-of-Capital Channel and the Conditional Role of Financial Distress Risk.

My doctoral research at Putra Business School, Malaysia (PhD in Finance, commenced 2026) examines whether debt maturity affects firm value through the cost-of-capital channel among Malaysian non-financial listed firms. The study positions WACC as a mediating mechanism between debt maturity and firm value, while financial distress risk is examined as a moderating condition. The research is grounded in capital structure theory, debt maturity theory, trade-off theory, and agency cost theory, and is intended to contribute to emerging-market corporate finance literature.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Capital structure; debt maturity; cost of capital; financial distress; firm value; emerging-market corporate finance.

Secondary: Corporate governance and financing decisions; asset pricing in thin/frontier markets; forensic analytics and data integrity; professional accounting education.

EDUCATION

PhD in Finance | Putra Business School, Malaysia | 2026 – Present
Full-time doctoral programme | In progress
Thesis: Debt Maturity and Firm Value in Malaysian Listed Firms: The Cost-of-Capital Channel and the Conditional Role of Financial Distress Risk

MBA in Accounting and Business Management | University of Finance and Economics, Mongolia | 2020
CFA/CIMA MBA Programme | ACBSP Accredited | GPA: 3.96/4.00
Thesis: The Cost Management Models to Support Corporate Strategy

B.Com in Accounting and Finance | *2003*
Avanthi Degree & PG College, Hyderabad, Telangana, India

RESEARCH ACTIVITY AND MANUSCRIPTS IN PROGRESS

Completed Research

MBA Thesis – The Cost Management Models to Support Corporate Strategy. University of Finance and Economics, 2020.

Examined strategic cost management tools – target costing, activity-based costing, benchmarking, TQM, and value chain analysis through systematic literature review and case study evaluation.

Manuscripts and Research Pipeline

1. Takiar, A. (2026). *An Empirical Evaluation of Benford's Law on Real-World Datasets and the Impact of Random Data Contamination.* Manuscript in preparation for Scopus-indexed submission; accepted for oral presentation at Applied Statistics 2026, University of Ljubljana, Slovenia.
2. Takiar, A. (2026). *Debt Maturity, Cost of Capital, and Firm Value in Malaysian Listed Firms.* Conceptual and empirical research design in progress, forming the basis of the doctoral research at Putra Business School.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP

Academic conference presentations:

- Takiar, A. (2026). *An Empirical Evaluation of Benford's Law on Real-World Datasets and the Impact of Random Data Contamination.* Accepted for oral presentation, Applied Statistics 2026 International Conference, University of Ljubljana, Slovenia, September 2026.
- Takiar, A. & Takiar, R. (2016). *Motivations and Reasons to Stay at Current Job.* Interdisciplinary International Symposium II, Royal International University, Ulaanbaatar.
- Takiar, A. & Takiar, R. (2014). *A Study of Some Socio-economic Changes in Mongolia.* Interdisciplinary International Symposium, Khunnu Palace, Ulaanbaatar.

Panel Moderation and Invited Talks

- **Lead Panel Moderator, Financial Elites International Conference 2026, Ulaanbaatar:** designed and moderated expert panels on AI in finance, digital transformation, enterprise value, and ethical risks in finance.
- Takiar, A. (2026). *Ethical Risks in the Digital Age: AI, Automation & Data Integrity.* Speaker, Pillar II – "From Compliance to Integrity: Redefining Ethics in Finance," Future of Finance & Professional Leadership 2026 International Conference (AMIRA), Ulaanbaatar.

RESEARCH SKILLS

Empirical Finance and Econometrics: Panel data analysis; fixed-effects and random-effects models; robustness testing; mediation and moderation analysis; introductory System GMM application.

Corporate Finance Measurement: WACC estimation; cost of equity; cost of debt; Tobin's Q; market-to-book ratio; leverage and debt maturity measures; financial distress indicators including Altman Z″-score.

Data and Statistical Analysis: Panel dataset construction; regression analysis; data cleaning; hypothesis testing; cross-sectional and time-series data handling.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Vice Director – Academic Affairs (Associate Professor) | IIAF, UFE, Mongolia *May 2026 – Present*

- Provide academic leadership for ACCA and CIMA programmes, including curriculum quality, assessment standards, teaching development, and student performance improvement.
- Lead assessment quality assurance through examination blueprinting, moderation, marking scheme review, and alignment with international professional body standards.
- Develop faculty capability through teaching observations, structured feedback, examiner-report analysis, and professional education benchmarking.
- Oversee student performance analytics and intervention systems to improve internal and external examination outcomes.
- Support strategic academic development in professional finance and accounting education, including the ACCA 2027 qualification transition.

Associate Professor & Consultant | University of Finance and Economics, Mongolia *Jan 2023 – Apr 2026*

- Delivered advanced corporate finance, performance management, and financial management teaching from Foundation to Professional levels; integrated valuation and cost-of-capital sensitivity analysis into applied coursework.
- Designed and maintained an assessment question bank aligned to ACCA/CIMA learning outcomes; introduced blueprinting and moderation controls across multiple examination sittings.

CIMA Programme Manager & Senior Lecturer | University of Finance and Economics, Mongolia *Jan 2017 – Jan 2023*

- Founded and scaled the CIMA training stream at UFE; structured the curriculum map and progression model across multiple cohorts.
- Delivered ACCA/CIMA/MBA subjects from Foundation to Professional levels; produced assessment rubrics, examination papers, and marking schemes across six subject areas.

Senior Lecturer | University of Finance and Economics, Mongolia *Jan 2015 – Dec 2016*

- Founded the university's CIMA training programme; designed syllabi, course materials, and assessment instruments across three subject areas.

Lecturer | University of Finance and Economics, Mongolia *Jan 2012 – Dec 2014*

- Delivered ACCA foundation-level Management Accounting and Financial Management to undergraduate cohorts.

Junior Lecturer | FTMS Global Academy, Ulaanbaatar *Mar 2009 – Dec 2011*

- Taught the ACCA Certified Accounting Technician (CAT) foundation programme.

SELECTED TEACHING AND SUPERVISION

Corporate Finance and Valuation:

- Advanced Financial Management (ACCA AFM)
- Financial Management (ACCA FM)
- Financial Strategy (CIMA F3)
- Risk Management (CIMA P3)

Performance and Management Accounting:

- Advanced Performance Management (ACCA APM)
- Performance Management (ACCA PM)
- Advanced Management Accounting (CIMA P2)
- Strategy and Competitive Analysis

Professional and Strategic Leadership:

- Strategic Business Leadership (ACCA SBL)
- Strategic Management (CIMA E3)
- Business Ethics & Professional Integrity

Supervision and Mentorship

- **Faculty Coach, CIMA Global Business Challenge:** mentored UFE student teams to Second Runner-Up, Global Final (2024, 2026), and Winner, Best AI Application Award (2026).
- Professional Mentor, Oxford Brookes University BSc (Hons) Applied Accounting: coached candidates through the Research and Analysis Project (RAP).
- Research supervision of undergraduate dissertations and capstone research projects across Accounting and Finance programmes.

PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

Completed

- Certified Management Accountant (CMA) – IMA, USA | *February 2019*
- Certified in Strategy and Competitive Analysis (CSCA) – IMA, USA | *November 2019*
- Chartered Global Management Accountant (CGMA) – AICPA/CIMA | *June 2020*
- Associate Chartered Management Accountant (ACMA) – CIMA, UK | *June 2020*
- Certified Corporate FP&A Professional (FPAC) – AFP, USA | *June 2021*
- Certified Fraud Examiner (CFE) – ACFE | *January 2023*
- ACCA Applied Skills Level Completed, Association of Chartered Certified Accountants, UK

In Progress

- Certification in Risk Management Assurance (CRMA) – IIA, USA.
- ACCA Strategic Professional – Advanced Financial Management (AFM) and Strategic Business Leadership (SBL).
- Financial Risk Manager (FRM) pathway – GARP.

GRANT APPLICATIONS AND FUNDING ACTIVITY

- **Principal Investigator, Internal Research Grant Application, UFE:** Professional Accounting Education and Graduate Employability Outcomes. USD 4,500. Submitted, 2026.
- **Principal Investigator, Internal Research Grant Application, UFE:** AI Disruption and the Future of Accounting and Finance Roles. USD 4,200. Submitted, 2026.
- Developing external funding applications for professional accounting education and finance-related research through ACCA/CIMA research funding channels.

EXECUTIVE TRAINING, CONSULTING AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Designed and delivered executive training in business ethics, professional integrity, and business valuation for corporate clients and finance professionals.
- Former Audit Manager with experience managing audit engagements, audit teams, and regulatory reporting.
- Independent accounting consultant, advising on accounting systems and internal control frameworks.
- Accounting Policy Advisor, Oyu Tolgoi Catalyst Fund, 2023.

– Board Member, AMIRA, with governance and financial accountability responsibilities.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

– **Programme Director, CIMA Programme, UFE:** quality assurance, accreditation liaison, assessment moderation.
– **Accreditation Coordinator, ACCA bachelor programme:** evidence mapping and audit-readiness.
– **Academic Examiner:** developed and moderated examination question banks across ACCA and CIMA subject areas.
– **Course Reviewer & Tester (Volunteer), IMA, USA:** validated professional development courses prior to launch.

HONOURS AND AWARDS

– AMIRA's Lifetime Contribution Award – Best of the Best Category | *2025*
– Top Educator Award – Ministry of Education, Mongolia (Higher Education Category) | *2024*
– Mongolian Youth Federation Young Leader Award | *2023, 2019, 2016*
– Entrepreneurship Spirit – Mark of Respect, MNCCI | *2020*
– Dean's Choice Award – University of Finance and Economics, Mongolia | *2013*

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

– Institute of Management Accountants (IMA), USA
– Chartered Institute of Management Accountants (CIMA), UK
– Association of Certified Fraud Examiners (ACFE)
– Association for Financial Professionals (AFP).

LANGUAGES

English (Professional Proficiency) • Hindi (Native) • Mongolian (Working Proficiency)

REFEREES

Referees available upon request.